AAPL Stock Report

1. Asset and Data

This report analyzes the stock performance of Apple Inc. (ticker: AAPL) over roughly one year, from September 29, 2025 to September 25, 2026. I downloaded 250 trading days of daily data from Yahoo Finance and used the daily closing price and trading volume as the basis for the analysis. I chose the closing price over the adjusted close because the goal is to describe the price investors actually saw each day. I completed the analysis in Python using Google Colab, and the notebook loads the data from GitHub so anyone can reproduce the results.

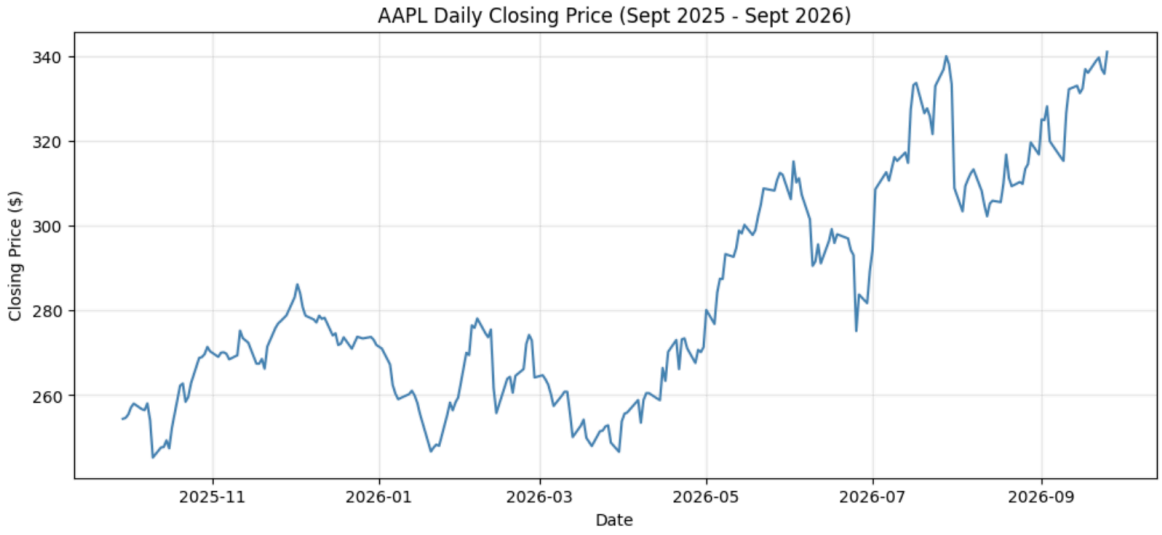
2. Descriptive Evidence

Table 1: Summary Statistics for AAPL Daily Closing Price

Statistic	**Closing Price**
Total Count	250
Mean	$283.42
Median	$273.96
Standard Deviation	$26.27
Minimum	$245.27
Maximum	$341.07

Table 1 summarizes the closing price. AAPL averaged $283.42 with a median of $273.96, and the mean sitting above the median points to a right-skewed distribution. The stock spent much of the year at lower prices, and a smaller group of high-priced days pulled the average up. The prices ranged from $245.27 to $341.07, a spread of about 39%, and the standard deviation of $26.27 confirms real movement rather than a flat year.

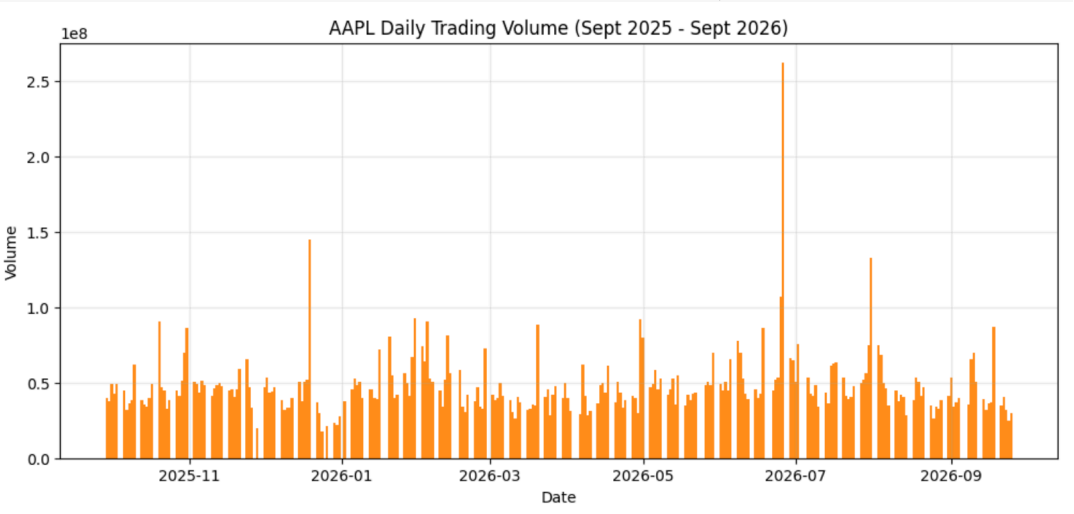
Figure 1: AAPL Daily Closing Price (September 2025-September 2026)




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Starting Price: $254.43 on 2025-09-29
Ending Price: $341.07 on 2026-09-25
Overall Change: 34.05%
Largest Single-day Gain: 4.84% on 2026-07-02
Largest Single-day Loss: -7.35% on 2026-07-31
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Figure 1 shows the overall direction. The stock opened the period at $254.43 and closed at $341.07, a gain of about 34%, and it finished at its highest close of the year. The climb was not smooth. Prices were most stable in November and December 2025, when the standard deviation of daily returns fell below 1%, and most volatile in February, June and July 2026, when it reached 2.2% or higher. The summer brought the largest one-day gain of 4.84% on July 2 and the largest one-day loss of 7.35% on July 31.

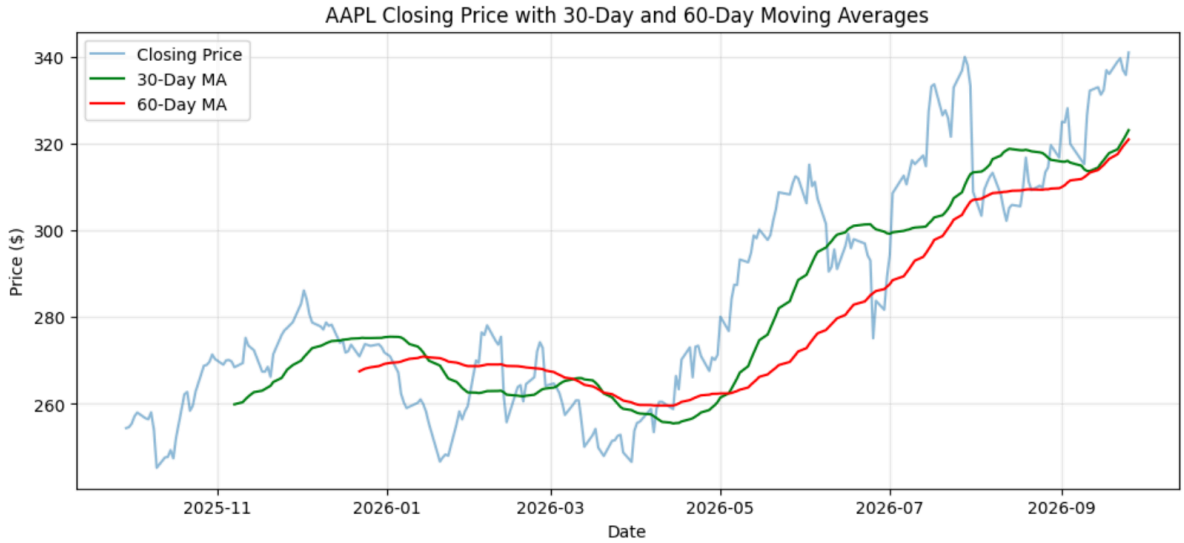
Figure 2: AAPL Daily Trading Volume




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Top 5 Highest-Volume Trading Days:
      Date      Close    Volume  Daily_Return
2026-06-26 283.779999 261775500      3.136473
2025-12-19 273.670013 144632000      0.543742
2026-07-31 308.910004 132489100     -7.353864
2026-06-25 275.149994 107013700     -6.117781
2026-01-30 259.480011  92443400      0.464617
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The trading volume averaged 48.3 million shares a day with a median of 44.6 million, so volume also skewed right because of a few very busy days. Figure 2 shows these spikes. The busiest day, June 26, 2026, saw 261.8 million shares change hands and lined up with the June Russell index rebalance, when the Russell indexes updated their member companies (LSEG, 2026). December 19, 2025 ranked second at 144.6 million shares, yet the price moved only 0.54%. This date was a "triple witching" day, when many options and futures contracts expire at once and lift trading across the whole market (Axios, 2025). These two spikes show that heavy trading can come from routine market mechanics rather than Apple news.

Figure 3: AAPL Closing Price with 30-Day and 60-Day Moving Averages



Points Where the 30-day MA Crosses the 60-day MA:

Date	Close	MA30	MA60
2026-01-16	255.529999	269.988997	270.745166
2026-03-10	260.829987	265.877000	265.479998
2026-03-20	247.990005	262.419333	262.595499
2026-05-04	276.829987	262.447333	262.433333

Figure 3 adds 30-day and 60-day moving averages, which smooth out the daily noise. The 30-day average crossed below the 60-day average on January 16 and March 20, 2026, and crossed back above it on March 10 and May 4, 2026. This back-and-forth marks a choppy early 2026 with no clear direction. After the May 4 crossover, the 30-day average stayed above the 60-day average for the rest of the sample, signaling a steady uptrend that is hard to spot in the daily price line alone.

3. Event Analysis

I picked three events directly from the biggest moves in the data and compared the five trading days before and after each one. Table 2 summarizes the results, and the event day itself is left out of both averages.

Table 2: AAPL Price and Volume Before vs. After Each Event

Measure	**Event 1: Price Hikes (June 25)**	**Event 2: iPhone Report (July 2)**	**Event 3: Q3 Earnings (July 31)**
Prior Close	$293.08	$294.38	$333.43
Event Day Close	$275.15	$308.63	$308.91
Event Day Change	-6.12%	+4.84%	-7.35%
Event Day Volume	107.0 million	75.4 million	132.5 million
Avg Close, 5 Days Before	$295.67	$284.88	$336.33
Avg Close, 5 Days After	$291.58	$313.65	$309.91
Change in Avg Close	-1.38%	+10.10%	-7.85%
Avg Volume, 5 Days Before	55.7 million	110.1 million	56.0 million
Avg Volume, 5 Days After	103.8 million	43.9 million	54.6 million
Close 5 Days Later vs. Prior Close	+5.31%	+7.11%	-6.03%

Event 1: On June 25, 2026, Apple raised prices on MacBooks, iPads and home devices to offset rising memory chip costs (CNBC, 2026a). The stock fell 6.12% that day on 107.0 million shares, nearly double the prior five-day average of 55.7 million. However, the drop did not last. The average close slipped only 1.38% in the week after. The volume stayed high at 103.8 million a day, but mostly because of the June 26 Russell rebalance. The evidence fits a strong one-day reaction but not a lasting effect.

Event 2: Late on July 1, Nikkei Asia reported that Apple planned at least five new iPhone models and a larger production run for its first foldable iPhone (Nikkei Asia, 2026; CNBC, 2026b). On July 2, the stock gained 4.84%, its best day of the year, and the average close rose 10.10% from the week before to the week after. However, the week before includes the June 25 drop and the June 26 rebalance, so part of this gain likely reflects a rebound rather than a reaction to the news alone.

Event 3: Apple reported fiscal Q3 results after the market closed on July 30. Revenue beat expectations, but the company gave a weak forecast and warned of tighter supply (CNBC, 2026c). On July 31, the stock fell 7.35% on 132.5 million shares, and the average close dropped 7.85% in the following week. Five trading days later, the stock still sat 6.03% below its pre-event price. This event shows the strongest link of the three, since the drop came right after the report, arrived on heavy volume and held. Still, the timing shows a relationship, not proof of cause.

4. 30-Day Price Range

I estimate AAPL will trade between about $317 and $365 over the next 30 days, centered on the last close of $341.07. The first piece of evidence is volatility. Daily returns had a standard deviation of 1.55% over the full year, and scaling that across 21 trading days gives an expected move of about 7.09% in either direction. The second piece of evidence is history. Across 229 past 21-day stretches, 64.2% landed inside this range, close to the 68% a one-standard-deviation range should capture. Most misses landed above the range (66) rather than below it (16), which reflects the year's uptrend and suggests the range may play it safe on the upside. Third, the lower bound sits just below the 30-day average of $323.17 and the 60-day average of $321.02. This approach assumes the next month behaves like the past year, with similar volatility and no built-in upward or downward drift.

5. Limitations and Conclusions

The data show that AAPL rose about 34% over the year and saw its largest price and volume swings around company-specific news in June and July. The analysis cannot prove that any event caused a price move, since other market forces could have played a role, and the Russell rebalance shows how volume can spike for reasons unrelated to Apple. The price range also has limits. First, it cannot predict surprise news, and one earnings report moved the stock more than 7% in a day. Second, real returns do not follow a perfect bell curve, and the July 31 drop equaled about 4.7 times normal daily volatility. Third, the range rests on one year of data from a strong uptrend. The historical data can support a reasonable business judgment, but it cannot replace an understanding of the news and risks that move a stock.

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